3 Understanding the business goals: Feature Injection and related techniques

This chapter covers

- High-level requirements-analysis techniques
- Using Feature Injection to identify business goals and supporting features
- Visualizing high-level requirements with Impact Mapping
- Identifying stakeholders and their roles

Before you can implement a software solution, and before you can even judge what features you should implement, you need to understand the problem you're solving and how you can help. Who will be using the system, and what benefits will they expect from it? How will your system help users do their jobs or provide value to your stakeholders?

How can you know if a particular feature will really benefit the organization as you suppose it should? Are you building software that will have a measurable, positive impact for your client's business? Will your project make a difference? Sometimes a particular feature, or even a particular application, shouldn't be implemented because it will clearly not deliver the business benefits expected of it.

This makes for a lot of unknowns. And as we discussed in chapter 1, you'll rarely understand the requirements completely or correctly at the start of a project, and